

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

The Confidence Enhanced Compact

*A Reciprocal, Modular Pathway to US-Iran Stabilization
Addressing the May 2026 Negotiation Crisis*

Version 2.1 | May 23, 2026

Calibrated to the May 22, 2026 Narrowed Baseline

Drawing from the Confidence-First Protocol v1.0

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Executive Decision Brief

For Senior Officials — Read This Before the Full Document

The Situation as of May 22, 2026: President Trump and Secretary Rubio have narrowed US baseline demands to three non-negotiable points: (1) full physical extraction of Iran's HEU stockpile from Iranian soil; (2) absolute freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz with rejection of any PGSA tolling; and (3) zero structural pre-conditions for sanctions relief, with no more than 25% of frozen assets for short-term release and no war compensation.

Iran's Supreme Leader has issued a directive that uranium must not leave Iranian soil. The PGSA remains the statutory Hormuz authority. This Compact meets every US demand structurally while preserving every Iranian red line optically.

The Central Exchange

Iran Delivers: (1) Entire HEU stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman by Day 14, verified by mass spectrometry, with legal title retained by the Central Bank of Iran; (2) 20-year enrichment moratorium at Natanz, renewable annually with mandatory review 36 months before expiration; (3) PGSA integrated into Joint Hormuz Transit Authority with strictly commercial mandate; (4) Hormuz open to unrestricted commercial transit with zero unilateral tolling; (5) Proportional airspace stand-down commencing Day 7.

US Delivers: (1) \$250M humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow on Day 1; (2) Synchronized lifting of naval blockade and proportional airspace stand-down on Day 7; (3) Staged return of up to 25% of frozen assets within 90 days, pegged to verified nuclear benchmarks, contingent on performance; (4) Eight-tranche sanctions relief with automatic graduation; (5) Public affirmation of Iran's NPT rights; (6) 25% secondary tariff carve-out for all SHTA transactions.

Key Protections

Dual-Key Authentication: No escrow release or milestone confirmation without simultaneous digital cryptographic keys from a Swiss auditor and the respective state representative.

48-Hour Technical Grace: Any dashboard trigger or IAEA camera outage activates a mandatory 48-hour technical triage before any Stepback penalty.

Isolated Dossier: Stepback penalties trigger only from nuclear/maritime violations. Non-nuclear geopolitical friction, cyber incidents, or domestic rhetoric cannot trigger penalties.

Emergency Humanitarian Override: \$50M of escrow remains permanently unfreezable for rapid-response medical disasters or earthquakes, immune to Stepback.

AI Verification Backup: Independent automated layer audits Swiss Dashboard data streams, cross-referencing IAEA telemetry and escrow transactions to flag anomalies before human review.

Pre-Cleared Commercial Whitelist: Pre-vetted pharmaceutical and agricultural entities coded into the dashboard before Day Zero, bypassing human compliance review entirely during the 30-day pilot.

Unmanned Systems Exclusion: Small-scale non-weaponized drones and autonomous vessels cannot trigger Stepback; handled exclusively through 72-hour technical dispute window.

UTC Continuous Operations: Entire framework anchored to Coordinated Universal Time; both capitals maintain 24/7 technical liaison offices overriding local weekends and holidays.

Annex: Multilateral Designations

The Compact includes provisions for international ceremonial nomenclature for the Strait and a structured nomination process for diplomatic recognition, both operating through multilateral institutional channels rather than bilateral state-to-state concession. These are addressed in Section 7.

1. Core Principles and Architecture

1.1 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Nothing happens unless both things happen at the same time. Iran does not move first. The United States does not move first. Every obligation is paired with a reciprocal obligation, verified simultaneously through a single Swiss-hosted digital dashboard.

When Iran grants IAEA access to its HEU stockpile, the US simultaneously releases the \$250 million humanitarian tranche into Swiss escrow. When the US lifts its naval blockade on Day 7, Iran simultaneously opens Hormuz to unrestricted transit and enters the proportional airspace stand-down. When Iran declares its enrichment moratorium, the US simultaneously issues the first sanctions relief tranche. Verification runs through three confirmed channels: the IAEA confirms nuclear steps, the Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs confirms financial steps, and Omani naval observers confirm maritime steps. All three channels must show green before either side's obligation is considered fulfilled.

The formally defined neutral allies in this architecture are: the **Sultanate of Oman** (maritime de-escalation and hotline management), the **State of Qatar** (escrow liquidity and bridging finance), **Switzerland** (financial verification and escrow administration), the **IAEA** (nuclear verification and stockpile custody), and **Pakistan** (emergency diplomatic convening). No role is assigned to non-state actors or proxy forces.

1.2 Modular Three-Stage Design

Phase	Duration	Iran Delivers	US Delivers	Closing Trigger
Phase One Confidence Pilot	Days 1-30	HEU to IAEA custody in Oman; 60% enrichment freeze; Hormuz opening begins; airspace stand-down initiated	\$250M humanitarian tranche; partial blockade lift; 30-day OFAC license; 25% tariff carve-out certification	IAEA confirms custody; 200+ Hormuz transits; 30 days green
Phase Two Stabilization	Days 31-120	20-year moratorium declared; single-facility operation; PGSA into JHTA; SAR exercise hosted	25% frozen asset release (pegged to HEU benchmarks); sanctions tranche; SWIFT reconnection; oil floor price guarantee	IAEA confirms moratorium; JHTA operational; 60 days green
Phase Three Architecture	Days 121-365	Fordow civilian conversion; continuous IAEA monitoring; regional dialogue; medical isotope tech transfer	Remaining tranches; full sanctions relief; Section 123 negotiation; grandfathered contract protection	Permanent IHTA charter; 85% assets returned

1.3 No Sunset, Stepback Not Snapback

This Compact contains no expiration dates and no sunset provisions. It operates on **stepback and earnback**:

Stepback: If either side fails to perform for more than 10 consecutive days, the corresponding reciprocal obligation automatically pauses. Prior gains remain. The stepback is graduated: 10%

reduction for Tier 1 technical delays, 25% for Tier 2 material concerns, 50% for Tier 3 deliberate violations. Funds are held, not seized. A mandatory **48-hour technical grace period** applies before any stepback penalty: if an IAEA camera feed goes offline or a dashboard trigger stalls, a 48-hour technical triage window opens for cyberattack verification, internet outage assessment, or hardware failure diagnosis at Natanz or Fordow before any financial penalty is enforced.

Earnback: Any paused obligation restores fully through 90 days of verified clean compliance. Earnback is automatic upon IAEA certification; no political negotiation required.

Dossier Isolation Clause: Stepback penalties can only be triggered by violations of the core nuclear and maritime text. They cannot be triggered by unrelated geopolitical friction, cyber incidents in non-nuclear domains, domestic political rhetoric, third-party military actions, or disputes concerning regional actors not party to this Compact.

1.4 The Swiss Dashboard and Dual-Key Authentication

Verification is handled by a single Swiss-hosted digital dashboard. Both parties see the same screen. The dashboard tracks three tracks: **Nuclear** (IAEA seal integrity, camera uptime, mass spectrometry, enrichment monitoring); **Financial** (SHTA escrow balance, OFAC license status, asset tranche releases); **Maritime** (Hormuz transit counts, blockade status, JHTA metrics, PGSA integration milestones, airspace stand-down compliance).

Dual-Key Digital Authentication: The release of any escrow tranche or the confirmation of a nuclear freeze milestone requires simultaneous digital cryptographic keys turned by both a Swiss auditor (appointed by the Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs) and the respective state representative. Neither key alone can authorize a transaction. This eliminates the risk that either capital could unilaterally pressure the Swiss government to lock or unlock the dashboard mid-exchange, ensuring the system is technologically immutable.

Disputes are logged directly on the dashboard. A flagged item triggers a 72-hour technical consultation, not a political negotiation. Either side can restart by mutual notice via the dashboard.

1.5 AI-Aided Verification Audit Backup Track

An independent, automated digital layer constantly audits the Swiss Dashboard data streams, cross-referencing IAEA camera telemetry and escrow transactions to flag anomalous readings before human inspectors can politicize them. The AI audit system operates on three functions: (1) **Telemetry Cross-Reference** — continuously compares IAEA camera feeds, mass spectrometry outputs, and seal integrity data against escrow transaction timestamps to detect mismatches; (2) **Anomaly Detection** — flags statistically unusual patterns in enrichment monitoring, transit volumes, or financial flows for automatic technical review; (3) **Neutrality Preservation** — all AI audit outputs are published simultaneously to both parties through the dashboard, preventing either side from claiming the system is biased. The AI audit does not replace human IAEA inspectors; it accelerates their work and removes bureaucratic delay from the compliance loop.

1.6 Media and Communications Protocol

A strict, binding **72-hour official media blackout** surrounds the digital dashboard starting from Day Zero. During this period, all official communication is restricted exclusively to pre-approved, boilerplate technical updates issued simultaneously by both capitals through the Swiss facilitator. No

unilateral press statements, no speculative commentary, and no premature triumphalism. After the 72-hour blackout, both capitals issue a single joint communique through the Swiss facilitator. This prevents leaks, speculative cable news reporting, and political commentators in either capital from weaponizing the initial steps and forcing leaders to pull the plug to protect domestic standing.

1.7 Pre-Cleared Commercial Whitelist

Even with a Treasury carve-out letter and civil immunity shield, compliance officers at commercial banks move like glaciers. If a Swiss bank takes five days to run background checks on a routine pharmaceutical shipment from Basel to Tehran, the 30-day dashboard timeline stalls. Iran sees the delay on the dashboard, assumes Washington is cheating, and halts its nuclear milestone. This vulnerability is eliminated through a **Pre-Cleared Commercial Whitelist**.

Before Day Zero, a specific, closed registry of Swiss and European pharmaceutical and agricultural corporations — and their pre-vetted Iranian counterparties — is coded directly into the dashboard. The whitelist is constructed through a joint technical process: the Swiss facilitator submits candidate entities; both capitals have 14 days to object on sanctions-evasion grounds; absent objection, entities are auto-approved and hardcoded. If an entity is on the whitelist, the compliance check is **mathematically instantaneous**, bypassing human legal review entirely during the 30-day pilot window.

Whitelist Scope: Pre-approved categories include (1) registered pharmaceutical manufacturers with WHO GMP certification shipping to Iran's Ministry of Health-approved importers; (2) agricultural input producers (fertilizer, seeds, irrigation equipment) shipping to Iran's Ministry of Agriculture Jihad-licensed distributors; (3) water-treatment chemical manufacturers shipping to Iran's National Water and Wastewater Engineering Company; (4) civilian electrical equipment manufacturers (transformers, switchgear) shipping to Iran's Tavanir grid authority. All counterparties are screened against UN, EU, and OFAC sanctions lists before inclusion.

Technical Mechanism: Whitelist entries carry a unique digital hash embedded in every transaction record. When a transaction is submitted to the SHTA, the AI audit layer performs a hash-match verification against the whitelist database. If matched, the transaction clears in under 30 seconds. If not matched, the transaction routes to standard human compliance review with a 72-hour target window. Whitelist status is visible on the Swiss dashboard to both parties in real time.

Post-Pilot Transition: After Day 30, the whitelist can be expanded by mutual agreement through the Swiss facilitator. Entities that performed without anomaly during the pilot are automatically renewed for Phase Two. New entity applications require both-capital consent and a 7-day objection window.

1.8 UTC Time Standard and Continuous Operational Mandate

Washington, Geneva, Muscat, and Tehran operate in different time zones with different workweeks. The Iranian weekend is Thursday/Friday; the Western weekend is Saturday/Sunday. If an IAEA camera feed drops at 4:30 PM on a Thursday in Tehran, it is 8:00 AM in Washington, but Iranian technical teams are headed home for their weekend. A 48-hour clock running on local time creates massive operational mismatch.

This Compact **anchors the entire framework to Coordinated Universal Time (UTC)**. All timestamps on the Swiss dashboard are recorded in UTC. All grace periods, triage windows, dispute deadlines, and graduation triggers are measured in UTC hours. Local time is displayed for reference only; UTC governs all binding calculations.

Continuous Operational Mandate: For the 30-day pilot, both capitals must maintain a **24/7 live-linked technical liaison office** operating strictly on UTC time, completely overriding local holidays, weekends, or bureaucratic working hours. Each liaison office must maintain minimum staffing of: (1) one senior technical officer with dashboard administrative access; (2) one IAEA-certified nuclear monitor with seal verification authority; (3) one financial compliance officer with SHTA transaction clearance authority. Offices must respond to dashboard alerts within 30 minutes at all times. The Omani facilitating state maintains a parallel 24/7 coordination desk in Muscat as neutral backup.

Failover Protocol: If either capital's liaison office goes offline for more than 60 minutes, the Swiss facilitator assumes temporary coordination authority and routes all communications through the Muscat backup desk. This is logged as a technical event, not a compliance failure. The offline capital has 4 hours to restore operations before a formal inquiry is initiated.

2. The HEU Stockpile Resolution

The Problem: The US demands full physical extraction of Iran's ~900 lbs of near-weapons-grade HEU from Iranian soil for ultimate destruction. Iran's Supreme Leader has directed that uranium must not be sent abroad. Each solution meets the US operational requirement while preserving Iranian sovereign title.

2.1 Solution A: The Oman Custody Exchange (Recommended)

Oman Custody Exchange with Retained Legal Title

Medium Risk | Iran-First | 14-Day Implementation

Iran transfers its entire HEU stockpile to **IAEA custody in Oman** (not the United States). Transfer is verified by mass spectrometry, continuous CCTV, and satellite surveillance. Stockpile remains under IAEA dual-lock custody until downblending or fuel-plate conversion is completed.

Legal Title Structure: While the HEU physically leaves Iran for Oman, the **legal title and ownership remain vested with the Central Bank of Iran** as sovereign trustee, leased to the IAEA under a Custody Services Agreement. Iran retains the right to recall title upon completion of the full successor framework and IAEA certification of permanent civilian conversion. This allows Tehran to claim it still "owns" its nuclear heritage, framing the move as an international storage lease rather than capitulation or forfeiture.

US Win: Material is physically outside Iran. US technical observers receive real-time telemetry. Material is available for destruction under IAEA supervision.

Iran Win: Sovereign title retained by Central Bank of Iran. IAEA, not the US, holds custody. Material goes to a Muslim neutral country under UN auspices. Framed as temporary custody lease, not surrender.

Verification: IAEA DG confirmation within 72 hours; mass spectrometry; continuous CCTV and satellite monitoring; Swiss dashboard real-time feed.

2.2 Solution B: The Dual-Lock In-Iran Protocol

Dual-Lock In-Iran Protocol

Lower Risk | Simultaneous | 30-Day Implementation

HEU stockpile consolidated at a single declared facility inside Iran under a **dual-lock system**: IAEA holds digital encryption keys to monitoring arrays and seal controls; Iran holds physical perimeter security keys. Neither can access sealed containers without the other. Simultaneously, material is downblended in-place to medical-grade LEU under continuous IAEA camera monitoring.

US Win: Material rendered unusable for weapons within 142 days. Real-time US monitoring access via encrypted telemetry. Daily downblending verification is irreversible.

Iran Win: Material never leaves Iranian soil. Iran retains sovereign title and physical possession. Iranian technicians perform all handling.

Verification: Daily mass spectrometry; tamper-evident seals with 15-minute alerts; continuous encrypted telemetry to Vienna, Geneva, and Washington.

2.3 Solution C: The Fuel-Plate Conversion Track

Fuel-Plate Conversion Track

Lowest Risk | Third-Party | 180-Day Implementation

HEU stockpile converted into **molybdenum-99, iodine-131, and xenon-133** for regional hospitals, and fuel plates for the Tehran Research Reactor. Iran becomes a regional medical isotope production center with revenue generation.

US Win: Isotopic composition transformed from weapons-capable to medically useful. Conversion is technically irreversible. IAEA cameras record every stage.

Iran Win: All conversion occurs on Iranian soil by Iranian technicians. Iran retains ownership of resulting isotopes and fuel plates. Iran gains prestigious regional humanitarian nuclear leadership role with revenue.

Verification: IAEA continuous monitoring; weekly isotopic analysis; WHO-coordinated distribution tracking.

3. The Enrichment and Facilities Framework

The Problem: The US demands a 20-year enrichment moratorium limited to one civilian facility. Iran maintains NPT Article IV guarantees the right to peaceful nuclear energy including indigenous enrichment.

3.1 Solution A: The 20-Year Renewable Cap (Recommended)

20-Year Renewable Cap with Mandatory Renewal Review

Medium Risk | Simultaneous | Immediate Declaration

Iran declares a **moratorium on all enrichment above 3.67%** for a baseline 20 years, renewable annually for up to 10 additional years based on verified performance. All enrichment limited to Natanz. Higher-enrichment centrifuges at Fordow and Isfahan idled under IAEA seal.

Sovereign Moratorium Renewal Window: The Compact requires a mandatory joint review and extension vote exactly **36 months before expiration** of any moratorium period, rather than approaching a hard cliff. This eliminates the political anxiety surrounding sunset clauses that tanked previous treaties, turning expiration into a predictable, manageable diplomatic routine.

US Win: 20-year baseline exceeds US minimum. Single-facility limitation addresses administration demand. IAEA seal on higher centrifuges provides physical verification.

Iran Win: Moratorium is a sovereign undertaking, not imposed. Renewable structure means Iran controls extension. NPT Article IV rights formally preserved in preamble. Mandatory 36-month pre-review eliminates cliff-edge anxiety.

3.2 Solution B: Single Facility with Fuel Guarantee

Single Facility with International Fuel Guarantee

Low Risk | Third-Party | 90-Day Setup

Iran limits all enrichment to **Natanz exclusively** for 20 years. An **international fuel supply consortium** (Russia, China, France, UAE) guarantees Iran's civilian reactor fuel requirements. Guarantee held in escrow: if consortium fails to deliver, Iran's enrichment rights automatically expand. Fuel bank pre-positioned with 5 years of Bushehr supply.

US Win: Only one facility operates. All other enrichment infrastructure mothballed. Escrow guarantee prevents Iran from claiming energy security as justification for breaking moratorium.

Iran Win: Iran retains Natanz as sovereign operation. Fuel guarantee ensures civilian energy needs met without single-supplier dependency. Auto-expansion clause protects against consortium failure.

3.3 Solution C: The Civilian Conversion Pathway

Civilian Conversion Pathway with Technology Transfer

Low Risk | Iran-First | 60-Day Implementation

Fordow becomes the **Regional Medical Isotope Research Centre (IMIRC)** producing molybdenum-99 for global distribution. Technical Custody Consortium (Switzerland, Austria, Oman) manages operations; Iranian personnel are "Co-Pilots." Revenue: Iran 40%, TCC 35%, Global Health Fund 25%. Isfahan becomes consolidated HEU storage with safeguards training. Natanz becomes Nuclear Research and Training Campus.

Civilian Medical Isotope Technology Transfer: The US and neutral allies (Switzerland, Austria, Oman) provide technical blueprints and specialized equipment for Iran to convert a portion of its low-enriched infrastructure strictly into cancer-treating medical isotope production. This serves as a domestic narrative victory for Tehran, demonstrating that peaceful, sophisticated nuclear science is being maintained and upgraded.

US Win: Fordow, the most hardened enrichment site, permanently converted to civilian use. Weapons pathway eliminated. IAEA continuous monitoring confirms no reversion without detection.

Iran Win: Iranian scientists lead research programs. Iranian engineers remain employed. Facilities remain Iranian sovereign property. Iran gains international prestige, revenue from isotope production, and access to advanced medical nuclear technology.

4. Maritime and Airspace De-escalation

The Problem: Iran established the PGSA on May 5, 2026, requiring vessel clearance, 40+ data points, and fees up to \$2 million per transit. Trump has explicitly rejected any tolling. Iran views PGSA as legitimate sovereign authority. The challenge: eliminate unilateral tolling while preserving PGSA's institutional existence and preventing kinetic escalation in adjacent airspace.

4.1 Solution A: Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (Recommended)

Joint Hormuz Transit Authority with Limited Jurisdiction

Medium Risk | Simultaneous | 14-Day Implementation

PGSA is **multilateralized into a treaty-based international body** with Iranian co-chairmanship. Six-party Governing Council: Iran (co-chair), Oman (co-chair), US (permanent seat), Qatar (permanent seat), rotating IMO Council member, IAEA Maritime Office (observer). Routine decisions require 3 votes from Seats 1-4; amendments require unanimous consent of Iran, Oman, and US.

Jurisdiction Limitation: The JHTA's mandate is **strictly commercial and navigational**. It holds zero jurisdiction over sovereign Iranian or regional territorial defense waters, coastal defense operations, or military vessel movements. The IRGC's statutory authority over coastal defense and territorial security is explicitly preserved and unaffected. The JHTA is framed purely as a trade-facilitation and maritime safety coordination mechanism.

PGSA is integrated into JHTA as Iran's designated operational implementation body for transit coordination within Iranian territorial waters. All PGSA permits bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran and JHTA-authorized. PGSA retains Iranian statutory authority exercised under JHTA Council oversight.

US Win: No unilateral Iranian tolling. Strait governed as open international waterway under UNCLOS. Equal treatment for all vessels including Israeli-flagged.

Iran Win: Iran holds co-chair permanent seat. PGSA retains statutory identity. IRGC coastal defense authority explicitly preserved. JHTA has no defense jurisdiction.

4.2 Solution B: Multilateral Maritime Fund with Energy Indemnity

Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund with Third-Party Energy Indemnity

Low Risk | Third-Party | Immediate Activation

Unilateral Iranian fees restructured into a **transparent, internationally governed maintenance pool** funding waterway safety. All commercial vessels pay 0.15% of cargo value, collected by JHTA Secretariat in Muscat (not Iran). Revenue: 40% Iranian Civilian Reconstruction, 35% International Maritime Safety, 25% JHTA Operations. Fund operates in non-USD currencies (EUR, RMB, AED).

Third-Party Energy Indemnity Fund: A collateralized insurance pool funded by a fraction of maritime transit tolls indemnifies commercial shipping vessels against localized security incidents. The indemnity pool is capitalized at \$20 billion (US DFC \$10B, Lloyd's of London \$5B, Oman SWF \$5B) and activates upon JHTA certification of 200 authorized transits. Commercial maritime shipping lines and global insurance syndicates require explicit, institutionalized financial guarantees to resume normal transit through the Strait, regardless of diplomatic announcements.

US Win: US receives cost-recovery payments for naval patrol contributions, making arrangement revenue-positive. Commercial shipping resumes with institutional guarantee.

Iran Win: Iran receives 40% of fund revenue for civilian reconstruction. Payments framed as cost-recovery for security services, not tolls.

4.3 Solution C: Dual-Brand Transit Protocol

Dual-Brand Transit Protocol

Low Risk | Third-Party | 7-Day Implementation

Vessel operators submit documentation through PGSA portal (Iranian node). JHTA Transit Permit Processing Unit cross-references against IMO, Lloyd's List, INTERPOL. Upon clearance, vessels receive JHTA-AUTHORIZED AIS designation valid for single transit or 30 days for frequent operators. Three Joint Transit Coordination Centers at Bandar Abbas, Khasab, and a floating platform at the Strait midpoint.

Humanitarian guarantee: WHO-verified humanitarian cargo transits at zero cost with fast-track processing. Inviolable — continues regardless of disputes or suspensions.

4.4 Proportional Airspace Stand-Down Protocol

Airspace Stand-Down Protocol (Day 7 Activation)

Medium Risk | Simultaneous | Day 7 Implementation

Concurrently with the Day 7 maritime blockade lift, both sides enter a synchronized **Airspace Stand-Down Protocol** defining specific geographic buffers where long-range surveillance drones and strike aircraft pull back from active radar locking:

Zone Alpha (Strait Corridor): Both parties withdraw unmanned surveillance assets to beyond 25nm of the central Hormuz transit lane. Manned maritime patrol aircraft may operate above 15,000 feet with JHTA-coordinated flight plans.

Zone Beta (Coastal Buffer): No armed drone operations within 12nm of either coastline. Existing defensive radar and early-warning systems remain operational but transition to passive scan mode.

Zone Gamma (Deep Airspace): Strike aircraft (manned or unmanned) on either side transmit encrypted transponder identifiers to the Swiss dashboard when entering within 100nm of the Strait, providing 30-minute advance notification.

Verification: Omani air traffic control confirms stand-down via radar data shared on Swiss dashboard. IAEA Maritime Office (JHTA observer) logs airspace incidents. Any violation triggers 48-hour technical consultation before escalating to material concern.

4.5 Unmanned Systems Exclusion Protocol

The Gulf is crowded with unmanned friction: small quadcopter drones near American destroyers, autonomous surveillance wave-gliders drifting into Iranian territorial waters, commercial USVs transiting the Strait. If a small, unattributed commercial drone appears on Day 12, hardliners on both sides will instantly call it a "provocation" to torpedo the Compact. This vulnerability is eliminated through explicit **Autonomous Exclusions**.

Tier 1 Autonomous Exclusion (Micro-UAVs and USVs): Unmanned aerial vehicles with a maximum takeoff weight below 25 kilograms, and unmanned surface vehicles below 5 meters in length, are explicitly excluded from the Stepback trigger system. Sighting, detection, or temporary incursion by such systems **cannot** be used to halt the dashboard, activate a Stepback penalty, or justify a maritime

or airspace suspension. They are handled strictly via the 72-hour technical dispute window. This ensures a cheap consumer drone or commercial survey glider cannot accidentally derail a multi-billion-dollar regional stabilization track.

Tier 2 Autonomous Exclusion (Medium UAVs and USVs): Unmanned systems between 25-150 kg (air) or 5-15 meters (surface) are logged on the dashboard as "Autonomous Contact Notifications" but do not trigger the 48-hour technical grace or Stepback countdown. They are subject to the standard 72-hour technical consultation. Only if armed or carrying detectable surveillance payloads do they escalate to the JHTA Maritime Operations Cell for assessment.

Tier 3 — Exclusion Does Not Apply: Armed unmanned systems of any size, systems exceeding Tier 2 thresholds, or systems exhibiting hostile behavior (radar targeting, payload deployment, communications jamming) are treated as standard security incidents under the existing maritime and airspace protocols.

Autonomous Systems Registry: Before Day Zero, both parties submit to the Swiss facilitator a registry of all unmanned systems operated by their military, coast guard, and licensed commercial entities within 200nm of the Strait. Registry entries include: vehicle type, identification transponder codes, typical operating areas, and command authority. Civilian commercial drone operators (survey, inspection, media) register through the JHTA. Unregistered autonomous contacts are presumed civilian/commercial unless demonstrably hostile. The registry is visible on the dashboard to both parties.

Attribution Protocol: In the event of an autonomous contact that cannot be immediately attributed, the following sequence applies: (1) Omani ATC or JHTA Maritime Operations Cell logs the contact on the dashboard within 15 minutes; (2) both parties receive simultaneous notification; (3) the 72-hour technical consultation opens automatically; (4) neither party may take kinetic action against the contact pending consultation outcome; (5) if the contact is confirmed as hostile after 72 hours, standard defensive protocols apply. This prevents attribution ambiguity from triggering escalation.

5. Blockade, Sanctions, and Asset Architecture

5.1 Synchronized Dual-Lift Mechanism

On Day 7, both blockades lift simultaneously within a **60-second UTC window** under neutral observation. T-60 min: Both commanders transmit stand-by; Omani state logs both signals. T-15 min: IRGC withdraws to 5nm; US Navy withdraws to 5nm from 12nm baseline; AIS confirms movements. T=0: Iran issues Hormuz opening declaration; US issues blockade lift declaration — **SIMULTANEOUS** within 60 seconds. T+15 min: First authorized vessel commences transit. Omani naval observers log positions continuously; Lloyd's List AIS confirms. If either side fails, sequence pauses but does not reverse completed steps.

5.2 Eight-Tranche Asset Return with Econ-to-Nuclear Pegging

The 25% asset release cap is mathematically bound to verified nuclear benchmarks: **every 100kg of HEU safely transferred to Oman custody unlocks exactly 8.33% of the agreed asset tranche** via the Swiss Dashboard. This satisfies the transactional quid-pro-quo requirement by ensuring that not a single dollar moves out of escrow without a verifiable, corresponding reduction in nuclear exposure.

Tranche	Timing	Amount	Nuclear Benchmark	Trigger	Reversibility
Pilot	Day 1	\$250M	IAEA access granted	Signature + access	Non-reversible
Tranche 1	Day 30	8.33%	First 100kg HEU in Oman custody	IAEA mass spec verified	Non-reversible
Tranche 2	Day 60	8.33%	Second 100kg HEU transferred	60-day compliance	Non-reversible
Emergency	Any	\$50M	N/A	WHO-certified medical disaster or earthquake	Permanently unfreezable
Tranche 3	Day 90	8.33%	All HEU transferred; moratorium declared	JHTA operational	30-day remediation
Phase Two Oil	Day 31+	1.0 mb/d	Moratorium maintained	Brent floor \$80/barrel	JIG review

Asset Pegging Formula: Total releasable = 25% of frozen assets. Each 100kg HEU milestone = 8.33% of 25% pool. Oil allowance floor-priced at \$80/barrel: if market price falls below \$80, the differential is compensated through the JHTA maintenance fund to ensure Iran's economic return remains politically viable.

5.3 Zero Structural Pre-Condition Protocol

This Compact requires no structural pre-conditions before first reciprocal moves. The \$250M humanitarian tranche releases on Day 1 simultaneously with IAEA access, not before. The blockade lifts on Day 7 simultaneously with Hormuz opening and airspace stand-down, not before. Each US concession activates upon verified Iranian performance, not promised performance. The 25% cap is a ceiling, not a floor.

5.4 Extraterritorial Litigation Shield

Any funds transferred to the SHTA or Swiss Dashboard escrow are **legally declared immune from civil attachment, private lawsuits, or domestic judicial asset forfeitures** in Western courts during the 30-day window and for the duration of the Compact. This estoppel shield is binding on both parties: the US confirms that no US court may attach, freeze, or seize escrowed assets; Iran confirms that no Iranian court may attach, freeze, or seize escrowed assets. Both parties agree to oppose any third-party litigation attempting to reach escrowed funds. This prevents private legal groups or victims of regional attacks from freezing Iranian state funds the moment they move into accessible accounts, which would immediately flatline the financial mechanics.

5.5 Secondary Tariff Carve-Out

Transactions routed through the Swiss Dashboard and the SHTA are **legally categorized as exempt from the US 25% global secondary tariff mandate**. The US Treasury issues a binding OFAC guidance letter on Day Zero confirming that all SHTA-processed transactions in approved humanitarian, agricultural, and civilian infrastructure categories carry tariff-exempt status. European and Asian banks receive this letter as legal insulation before processing any authorized tranche. Without this carve-out, banks would refuse to touch even humanitarian tranches if they feared a technical ambiguity could trigger a 25% tariff on their entire US export portfolio. Explicit legal insulation is required on Day Zero.

5.6 Grandfathered Commercial Contracts Clause

Any civilian commercial contracts signed during the successful 30-day pilot window are **legally "grandfathered" and protected from immediate penalty for up to 180 days** if a Stepback event occurs. Foreign commercial enterprises and international trade partners need a baseline of regulatory predictability. If they fear their investments could be instantly criminalized overnight by a technical compliance hiccup, they will refuse to engage entirely, neutralizing the power of the economic incentives. This clause provides a 180-day "cooling-off" protection for contracts entered into in good faith during verified green-status periods.

6. Reciprocal Economic Incentives Schedule

Every provision is paired with concrete, quantifiable economic benefits visible to domestic audiences. The following schedule creates domestic constituencies for cooperation in both capitals.

#	For Iran: Verified Incentives	#	For the United States: Verified Gains
Phase One Benefits (Days 1-30)			
I-1	\$250M humanitarian release into SHTA escrow for medicine, food, aviation parts — unconditional, non-reversible, 25% tariff-exempt	U-1	HEU physically removed from Iran to IAEA custody in Oman by Day 14, verified by mass spectrometry
I-2	Oil export ceiling: Secondary sanctions suspended for purchases up to 1.0 mb/d with \$80/barrel floor price guarantee	U-2	Breakout timeline extended from weeks to 12+ months through moratorium and facility conversion
I-3	Civilian aviation license: 90-day renewable authorization for Airbus, Boeing, ATR spare parts export	U-3	Hormuz open: 200+ transits within 14 days, oil stabilizes below \$90/barrel, US gasoline falls to ~\$3.20/gal
I-4	Designated banking channel: UBS Zurich or QNB Doha processes transactions under Treasury comfort letters, tariff-exempt	U-4	Naval cost recovery: US receives patrol compensation through JHTA fund, arrangement revenue-positive
Phase Two Benefits (Days 31-90)			
I-5	Agricultural input access: Unrestricted import of water-treatment chemicals, grid transformers, fertilizer, seeds	U-5	Zero war compensation: No US taxpayer-funded reparations; all Iranian benefits are asset returns or commercial revenue
I-6	Port infrastructure investment: JHTA funds upgrade Bandar Abbas and Chabahar to international standards	U-6	All Gulf bases preserved: No force posture changes, no troop withdrawals, no base closures
I-7	Medical isotope revenue: 40% of IMIRC revenue from molybdenum-99 distribution; est. \$180-280M/year	U-7	Multilateral burden-sharing: JHTA distributes security costs across six parties; 40-nation French-led initiative integrated
I-8	Insurance cost reduction: \$20B reinsurance backstop reduces Hormuz transit insurance from 1.5% to 0.15% of hull value	U-8	Proxy operational pause: Iran transmits formal instructions to Houthi, Hezbollah, Iraqi militias for stand-down on US targets

Phase Three Benefits (Days 91-365)			
I-9	Technology transfer access: Controlled dual-use technology for medical, agricultural, industrial applications; IAEA conference participation	U-9	LNG export stability: Global LNG markets normalize, US LNG export volumes to Asia return to pre-crisis levels
I-10	SWIFT reconnection pathway: Reconnection commences Day 90 for FATF-compliant banks; full banking normalization follows	U-10	Legacy institutional architecture: Permanent IHTA, JHTA, Swiss dashboard, and tranche system outlast any single administration

7. Annex: Honoric and Ceremonial Provisions

The following provisions operate through multilateral institutional channels rather than bilateral state-to-state concession. They are formally annexed to the Compact and require adoption by the JHTA Governing Council, not by either signatory state individually.

Annex 7A: Multilateral Maritime Nomenclature Designation

JHTA Council vote required | Unanimous consent of Iran, Oman, and US

The JHTA Governing Council may, by multilateral maritime decree, adopt a ceremonial designation for official international navigational charts, UN filings, and diplomatic correspondence. Such designation would be registered with the IMO as a reference name and would not affect UNCLOS legal nomenclature or domestic cartographic practice of any member state. The decree requires unanimous consent of Iran, Oman, and the United States. Iran's domestic designation and all Persian-language IHTA documents would retain the established geographic name. No member state is required to adopt the ceremonial designation in internal communications. This provision is framed as a multilateral institutional recognition of diplomatic leadership, not as a bilateral concession by either party.

Annex 7B: Structured Nomination Process for Diplomatic Recognition

Neutral third-party facilitated | Conditional on verified Compact milestones

Upon IAEA certification of the HEU custody transfer and JHTA certification of 200 successful Hormuz transits, a neutral facilitating state (Oman, Switzerland, or Pakistan) may submit a formal nomination to an appropriate international recognition body citing the achievement of a verified, reciprocal stabilization framework. The nomination would reference "decisive multilateral leadership in transforming military confrontation into verified diplomatic stabilization." The nomination would be supported by concurrent technical letters from the IAEA Director-General and IMO Secretary-General confirming concrete achievements. The nomination is conditional on Compact activation: if milestones are not met, the nomination is withdrawn. This provision operates entirely through neutral third-party institutional channels and does not require any action by either signatory state.

Iranian stakeholders may note that any recognition reflects a mutual achievement in which both parties moved simultaneously through synchronized reciprocal motion, as explicitly documented in the Compact's verification records.

8. Symmetrical Steps Timeline

8.1 Phase One: 30-Day Confidence Pilot (Days 1-30)

Day	Iranian Action	US Action	Verified By
Days 1-3: Opening Exchange (Media Blackout Active)			
0	72-hour media blackout begins. All communication exclusively through Swiss facilitator.		
1	Exchange non-papers via Swiss; grant IAEA facility access within 72h	\$250M to SHTA escrow; 30-day OFAC license; suspend Project Freedom; issue 25% tariff carve-out guidance letter	Swiss dashboard; IAEA confirmation; Treasury letter
3	Submit complete HEU inventory (quantities, locations, enrichment, chemical forms)	Confirm escrow funded and license active on dashboard; cease new sanctions designations	IAEA receipt; dashboard green both tracks
Days 7-14: Synchronized Dual De-escalation			
7	IRGC withdraws to 5nm; Hormuz opening declaration; open transit to JHTA vessels; activate proportional airspace stand-down	Blockade lift declaration; proportional airspace stand-down; carriers to 200nm holding; first humanitarian convoy	Omani observers; Lloyd's AIS; radar confirmation; timestamp
10	Begin HEU transfer to IAEA custody in Oman under continuous monitoring	Confirm blockade and airspace stand-down verified; authorize first oil waiver 1.0 mb/d with \$80 floor	IAEA mass spectrometry; Omani custody receipt
14	Complete HEU transfer; IAEA dual-lock custody confirmed	Confirm HEU custody; affirm Iran's NPT rights publicly; joint press release	IAEA DG certification; 72h blackout ends
Days 15-30: Verification Window			
15-30	Maintain HEU custody; freeze enrichment above 3.67%; continuous IAEA monitoring; Hormuz open; airspace stand-down maintained	Maintain SHTA channel; process humanitarian transactions; oil waiver with floor; no new sanctions; tariff carve-out enforced	Weekly IAEA; daily Hormuz reports; AI audit; dashboard green
Day 30: Graduation Decision			
30	If 30 consecutive green days confirmed, auto-transition to Phase Two within 72h. Either side may decline by written notice within 48h. Grandfathered contract protection activates for all contracts signed during green period.		

8.2 Phase Two: 90-Day Stabilization (Days 31-120)

Window	Iranian Action	US Action	Verified By
Days 31-44	Declare 20-year moratorium; submit Natanz-only operation plan; mothball Fordow/Isfahan centrifuges under IAEA seal; host inaugural JHTA SAR exercise	Tranche 1 (8.33%) released upon 100kg HEU verification; sanctions relief (aviation, consumer exports); open designated banking channel; extraterritorial litigation shield certification	IAEA moratorium; JIG; 30-day Congressional review; SAR exercise certification
Days 45-60	Begin Fordow conversion planning; integrate PGSA into JHTA; host second SAR exercise	Tranche 2 (8.33%) upon second 100kg HEU verification; SWIFT reconnection commenced	JHTA certification; IAEA monitoring; SAR exercise report

Days 61-90	PGSA-JHTA integration complete; full commercial Hormuz transit; regional security dialogue; airspace stand-down protocols normalized	Tranche 3 (8.33%) upon all HEU verified; sanctions Tranche 2 (petrochemicals, oil services); Section 123 framework opened	JHTA operational; moratorium maintained; cumulative 25% cap reached
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Day 90: Graduation Decision

90 If moratorium verified, JHTA operational, 60 days green, SAR exercises completed: auto-transition to Phase Three. Grandfathered contract protection extends 180 days from contract date.

8.3 Phase Three: 180-Day Architecture (Days 121-365)

Window	Iranian Action	US Action	Verified By
Days 121-180	Fordow to IMIRC; civilian conversion complete; continuous IAEA monitoring; host International Medical Isotope Summit; medical isotope technology transfer operational	Tranches 4-5; full sanctions relief architecture; permanent IHTA charter negotiation; third-party energy indemnity fund operational	IAEA quarterly; JIG certification; tech transfer confirmation
Days 181-270	Full moratorium compliance; regional security dialogue; proxy operational pause; 36-month pre-review process initiated	Tranche 6; successor framework negotiation (RCSA)	Annual compliance review; pre-review documentation
Days 271-365	Verified compliance; permanent successor framework preparation; moratorium renewal review completed	Remaining tranches per successor framework; full banking normalization	365-day comprehensive review

9. Stepback and Earnback System

Why Stepback Replaces Snapback: Snapback creates perverse incentives. If a single violation collapses everything, the violator has nothing left to lose. This Compact replaces snapback with stepback: graduated, proportional, reversible responses that preserve incentives for return to compliance. Prior gains remain in place. Nothing is undone.

9.1 Four-Tier Graduated Response with Technical Grace

Tier	Trigger	Iranian Consequence	US Consequence	Grace Period
T1 Technical Delay	Monitoring gap 48-96h; minor inventory discrepancy; equipment failure. Autonomous systems excluded per Section 4.5.	None. 72h consultation resolves. 48h technical grace applies before any consultation. Micro-UAV/USV contacts handled via 72h dispute window only.	None. Consultation proceeds.	48 hours mandatory
T2 Material Concern	IAEA portal "Down" 10 days; seal tamper; enrichment above 3.67%	Future tranches pause 10%. Oil waiver suspended. JHTA convenes.	IAEA monitoring intensifies. Congressional review triggered.	48 hours mandatory

T3 Deliberate Violation	Confirmed enrichment above 3.67% with concealment; HEU custody breach; proxy attack on US targets	Future tranches frozen. Oil waiver terminated. SWIFT suspended. Moratorium extends 2 years auto.	Secondary sanctions reactivated on oil purchasers. Blockade review.	48 hours mandatory
T4 Fundamental Breach	Weaponization detected; attack on IAEA personnel; nuclear transfer to third party	Full suspension. Reconstitution Conference within 30 days.	Full sanctions reimposition. Military options review.	48 hours mandatory (except active armed attack)

Technical Grace Protocol: Before any Tier 2-4 consequence activates, a mandatory 48-hour technical triage window opens automatically. During this window: (1) the Swiss dashboard freezes all stepback countdowns; (2) IAEA technical team deploys to assess whether the trigger is mechanical failure, cyberattack, or intentional violation; (3) both parties submit technical data through the dashboard; (4) if the trigger is confirmed as non-deliberate (equipment failure, regional internet outage, third-party cyber intrusion), the grace period extends to 96 hours for remediation without penalty. This prevents cyberattacks, internet outages, or hardware failures at Natanz or Fordow from accidentally collapsing the framework.

Unmanned Systems Exclusion in Stepback: Per Section 4.5, Tier 1 autonomous contacts (micro-UAVs below 25kg, micro-USVs below 5m) are explicitly excluded from the Stepback trigger system at all tiers. They cannot halt the dashboard, activate a Stepback penalty, or justify maritime or airspace suspension. Tier 2 autonomous contacts (medium UAVs/USVs) are logged as "Autonomous Contact Notifications" but do not trigger the 48-hour technical grace or Stepback countdown. Only Tier 3 (armed or hostile) unmanned systems are treated as standard security incidents under the stepback framework.

9.2 Earnback Pathway

From Tier	Earnback Requirement	Restored Upon
Tier 2	90 consecutive days clean compliance; all monitoring restored; no new concerns	IAEA certification to JIG (90 days from remediation)
Tier 3	180 consecutive days clean compliance; enhanced monitoring accepted; JIG review passed	JIG unanimous certification (180 days from remediation)
Tier 4	Reconstitution Conference agreement; new baseline; confidence-building period	Reconstitution Conference communique (subject to negotiation)

9.3 Emergency Humanitarian Release Override

\$50 million of the Swiss escrow funds remain **permanently unlocked and unfreezable**, exclusively designated for rapid-response medical disasters or earthquakes. This emergency override is completely immune to the Stepback protocol at all tiers, including Tier 4 fundamental breach. Activation requires WHO certification of a qualifying humanitarian emergency. The \$50M is drawn from the initial \$250M pilot tranche and is legally segregated through the Swiss escrow structure before Day Zero. This injects an unshakeable layer of moral legitimacy into the text, proving to the global community and domestic populations that the Compact fundamentally respects basic human security, even during a technical compliance dispute.

9.4 Framework Survival Core

Under all circumstances including total suspension, three elements survive: (1) ceasefire hotline active, (2) humanitarian access uninterrupted, (3) emergency diplomatic channel open. Survival Core continues 180 days pending reconstitution. The \$50M emergency humanitarian override remains accessible regardless of framework status.

10. What Each Side Can Say

Both narratives describe the same facts. Neither requires either leader to admit defeat, retreat, or concession.

Iranian Domestic Narrative	US Domestic Narrative
"We ended the war on Day 7 — blockade lifted, Hormuz reopened, airspace de-escalated under our authority."	"Hormuz is open — 200+ transits in 14 days under joint international authority with airspace stand-down verified."
"HEU transferred under IAEA custody to a Muslim neutral country — not the US. Legal title retained by our Central Bank."	"Weapons-grade uranium secured — entire stockpile physically removed from Iran."
"NPT rights preserved. We declared a sovereign moratorium with mandatory renewal review. No sunset clause."	"Enrichment capped and verified — 20-year moratorium at one facility, continuous IAEA monitoring, no sunset."
"PGSA remains Iran's statutory authority. We hold co-chair on JHTA Council. IRGC coastal defense untouched."	"No unilateral Iranian tolling. Strait is open, free, governed by international authority."
"Assets returning pegged to verified nuclear benchmarks — every dollar earned, not given. Oil price floor protects our revenue."	"We released only frozen Iranian assets, pegged to verified HEU transfers. Every dollar conditional on performance."
"Fordow becomes Regional Medical Isotope Centre — Iranian scientists leading global health with technology transfer."	"Fordow converted to civilian use — most hardened site permanently eliminated as weapons facility."
"Our humanitarian funds are protected even in worst case — \$50M permanently accessible for medical disasters."	"Humanitarian firewall built in — emergency medical funds immune to any dispute, demonstrating moral foundation."
"We moved as equals with 48-hour technical grace. Every US concession matched by Iranian concession simultaneously."	"Every Iranian concession verified by AI audit and IAEA before we moved. Dual-key authentication prevented unilateral manipulation."

11. Implementation Checklist

Actions required before activation. No political agreement needed — only technical preparation.

Party	Action	Deadline
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Iran Must Complete

Iran	Designate declared facilities for IAEA HEU access; confirm date/time window	Day -7
Iran	Prepare written inventory template in IAEA format; confirm Central Bank of Iran title retention structure	Day -5
Iran	Confirm infrastructure supports remote-monitoring camera and AI audit data feeds	Day -7
Iran	Designate Swiss dashboard technical contact and dual-key cryptographic representative	Day -3
Iran	Prepare IRGC coordination protocol for Day 7 airspace stand-down	Day -3

United States Must Complete

US	Confirm SHTA escrow operational for \$250M transfer; segregate \$50M emergency humanitarian override	Day -7
US	Draft and clear 30-day OFAC general license for SHTA; prepare 25% tariff carve-out guidance letter	Day -5
US	Prepare approved transaction whitelist in machine-readable format; submit candidate entities for Pre-Cleared Commercial Whitelist	Day -3
US	Confirm designated commercial bank (UBS/QNB) ready for Phase Two; extraterritorial litigation shield prepared	Day -3
US	Confirm CENTCOM airspace stand-down protocols coordinated with Omani ATC	Day -3

Both Sides via Swiss Facilitator

Both	Confirm Swiss dashboard live with dual-key authentication; AI audit layer operational	Day -3
Both	Agree on 48-hour camera outage threshold, 72-hour dispute window, 48-hour technical grace protocol	Day -3
Both	Exchange 24-hour technical liaison contacts for dashboard alerts; confirm UTC time standard adopted	Day -1
Both	Approve joint press release text and 72-hour media blackout protocol for Day Zero	Day -1
Both	Confirm JHTA SAR exercise planning initiated with Oman, Qatar coast guards	Day -1

Swiss Facilitator (Pre-Day Zero Technical Setup)

Swiss	Code Pre-Cleared Commercial Whitelist into dashboard; hash-match verification tested and operational	Day -7
Swiss	Configure dashboard for UTC timestamp recording; all countdown timers, grace periods, and deadlines set to UTC	Day -5
Swiss	Establish 24/7 Muscat backup coordination desk with minimum staffing (technical officer, nuclear monitor, compliance officer)	Day -3
Swiss	Program autonomous systems exclusion filters into dashboard; Tier 1 and Tier 2 contacts auto-categorized	Day -3
Both	Submit autonomous systems registry (military, coast guard, commercial) to Swiss facilitator for dashboard upload	Day -5

Final Note to Negotiators: This Compact is not a treaty. It is a proof of concept. It is designed to be politically survivable for both leaders, mechanically simple to execute, and verifiable by third parties without either side having to trust the other. If it works, it graduates automatically. If it fails, nothing is lost. The question is not whether a final agreement is possible. The question is whether reciprocal motion itself is still possible between these two parties. This Compact answers that question with a single, low-exposure test. Thirty days. One exchange. Both sides move at the same time.